

## OREGON CITY COURIER

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E. R. BROWN, EDITOR AND PUBLISHER  
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## TROUBLES OF OTHERS

People who buy Portland newspapers these days to read about the doings of the world at large ought to be given a rebate. Usually one column on the front page and an indefinite number of columns inside the paper are taken up with a lot of bunk about the mean way the Southern Pacific is hauling freight over the mountains to Puget Sound instead of pulling it downhill to Portland, or else there is an outburst of "news" to the effect that when there is a west wind blowing and a high tide there is 37 feet of water on the bar of the Columbia when the waves are big. With the exception of the present debate between the Telegram and the Oregonian on the other, regarding lumber rates from Portland to California, there is nothing new or entertaining in all this stuff.

And the Portland lumber rate matter has been harped on so much lately that it is fast losing its novelty. It appears that Portland has discovered the truth about herself, and that she is trying to hypnotize herself into believing that it isn't true at all. The basic idea underlying all these newspaper outbursts of "civic patriotism" is the same; namely that as a port of commerce Portland is a joke. The proud city down the Willamette is a commercial joke for the simple reason that it has nothing to export—all its business is imported. In spite of the brilliant but fanciful remarks issued by the Portland commercial bodies, its industries are a minus quantity. It has a few lumber mills and a couple of factories; but the city itself is able to absorb practically the entire output of these plants, and so there is nothing in particular for Portland to export. And when trade is all one way, railroads and steamship lines are not crazy to make a terminal point.

Portland is, aside from an importing center, a sort of a clearing house and shipping point for the very limited product of the country ports, and it acts as a distributing agent to a small percentage of Oregon towns. But this business does not originate in Portland—it is shipped into Portland along with the great mass of Portland imports, and is then distributed by local service to perhaps a score of lesser distributing points. Portland business is one-sided, and therefore Portland cannot claim the same consideration from transportation companies that is given cities whose business is both imports and exports.

It is cheaper for a railroad, for instance, to haul loaded freight cars "over the mountains to Puget Sound," because these same freight cars may be hauled back again over the mountains jammed full of shipments of freight. If they were hauled into Portland they would have to be taken away empty—and there is no money in hauling empty freight cars, not even on a water grade. Portland doesn't get the business that goes to Puget Sound because it cannot offer the return business that Puget Sound does. Portland cannot compare with Tacoma, for instance, as a railroad terminal, for even if all other things were equal, Portland has not got the vast manufacturing plants that dot Tacoma's tidelands.

But not only does Portland lack the manufacturing plants of the Sound cities, but it also lacks deep-sea commerce. The mere fact that there may be forty feet of water on the Columbia bar will not make Portland a port for deep water vessels. If there was a hundred feet of depth over the bar, Portland would be no better off than she is today unless the 160 miles of river between the bar and Portland was dredged, a wide channel maintained, and decent docking facilities provided at Portland. As things are today, in spite of all denials to the contrary from Portland, an ocean-going vessel can get to Vancouver, Washington, with reasonable safety and dispatch; but if a vessel of heavy draft tries to ascend the Willamette to Portland, it is a subject for extra risk and insurance.

And at the root of all this woe that is stacked up for Portland in any fight for commercial advance, there

underlies the Portland spirit—a spirit as deadly to progress as any in the world. Portland moneyed men will not invest their own capital in their own city. This has been proven time and time again when efforts have been made to put up large buildings in the business section of the city. With the exception of the Wilcox properties, and those controlled by C. K. Henry and perhaps one or two others, Portland is a city of buildings and enterprises built upon borrowed capital.

Instead of utilizing columns of space in fruitless weeping and in complaint against the railroads and steamship lines, Portland papers should "jar" and "hammer" Portland's own citizens, and try to awaken them to the harm they are doing the city by their selfishness and by their fear to invest in the city they call "home." Let Portland make itself a manufacturing city, let it put some of its own capital into its enterprises—and then transportation problems will take care of themselves. Railroads will climb mountains to get business, as the Puget Sound traffic shows; but if the business was to be had in Portland, railroad would gladly follow a water grade to get that business.

The fault lies with Portland, and not with the outside interests.

## MORE ABOUT ROADS

Uncle Sam is always attentive to the needs of his nephews and nieces, though they do not always appreciate it. And particularly does Uncle Sam try to benefit those of his nephews who live far removed from the maddening life of cities. And the one thing that the farmer needs more than anything else is good roads over which he may haul his produce to market. This applies to Clackamas county, as well as to the neighborhood near Waughkegan, Maine; in fact the matter of roads are probably of greater interest to us here than to people in any other locality.

For the most part hereabouts we are blessed (?) with what are known as dirt roads. Perhaps "mud roads" would be the better term, but that is due to our climate, and to the apparently pronounced habit of some of our road-builders to build from the top down; instead of from the bottom up. Knowing these things, the Courier takes the liberty herewith of passing on some advice on the general subject of keeping roads passable in winter time, that has been sent us by the department of agriculture. The advice follows.

Water, not cold, is the cause of deterioration of roads in winter, according to the road specialists of the department. Cold weather does not in itself injure roads, no matter whether they are earth, gravel, or macadam. In fact, an earth road will stand more traffic when it is solidly frozen than at any other time. Excessive water, however, is always detrimental to a highway. When cold weather turns this water into ice, the damage that it does is greatly increased. Ice occupies considerably more space than the water from which it is formed, and every person who has lived in a cold climate is familiar with the powerful bursting effect of water when left to freeze in a confined vessel. The same action takes place when a wet road freezes to any considerable depth. It simply bursts, or, as we generally term it in road parlance, the road heaves.

A dry road will not heave. Rock, gravel, sand and even clay when perfectly dry contract slightly on freezing. In order to expand on freezing these materials must contain or be mixed with water, and the more water they contain the greater the expansion which takes place. But so long as the road remains frozen the damage does not become apparent. Hence the frequent and erroneous idea that it is the thaw which injures the road. The injury was done when the water in the road froze and the particles of the road surface—broken stone, sand, or still finer particles of earth or clay—were pushed apart by the expanding power of the freezing water. The thaw merely allows the ice to melt and assume its original volume as water.

The remedy is self-evident. Keep the water out of the road. The time to

begin preventive measures is early in the fall, before the rains begin. If the road goes into the winter thoroughly dry, with the surface and drainage in good condition, the chances are extremely favorable that it will come out all right the following spring.

Keep the ditches and drains open. Remove all accumulations of weeds, grass, etc., which tend to retain moisture and obstruct drainage. Furthermore, do this work early, while the ground is still dry and hard. Vegetation and litter hold water like a sponge and allow it gradually to soak in and soften the earth. The job before the road man is to keep the hard, dry surface formed in the summer time from becoming softened by the fall and winter rains and snows. When the fall rains begin the earth or gravel roads should be dragged frequently to prevent the formation of ruts and the collection of water. All raveled places on macadam surfaces should be carefully filled in and consolidated.

And now, lest some bright supervisor rises to remark that roads in Clackamas county do not freeze very much in winter, let it be remembered that the moral of this advice from Uncle Sam is NOT to prevent roads from freezing; but to keep them well drained ALL THE TIME. Then the climate will not raise such havoc with them.

## TO THE SOUTH OF US

Mabel Hite, now one of the stars of the musical comedy world made her reputation in the Northwest singing a song about, "Mexico, my dark-eyed Mexico," on the vaudeville circuits in the Puget Sound country. And now the whole country is thinking about

bring home to the republics that lie between the Atlantic and Pacific oceans the folly of spending all the money that can be begged, borrowed or simply taken, in exploding powder and shooting up human beings. What is the growing realization of what is happening in Mexico, and its dreadful consequences, will utterly spoil the plans of jingoes in the United States who want to get all ready to "lick Germany or whatever else is left in Europe." Probably the Mexico muss will so disgust this nation with warfare that there will not be any immediate plans made for sending a few million Americans to the next world by the gun-powder route.

Mexico, of course, is paying a terrible price to teach her sister republics on the twin American continents the value of peace; but it appears that somebody has got to pay the price on this side of the ocean. Europe has probably partly learned the lesson of the brotherhood of man by this time, and as soon as Europe is able she will probably put her knowledge to practical use. And probably Mexico will too. And when all this comes to pass, and the dove of peace can once again encircle the globe without getting her wings singed and her eyes peppered out; probably there will be some general gratitude to Mexico in this country for driving home the lesson—and perhaps even Mabel Hite will again sing "Mexico, my dark-eyed Mexico," and be heartily applauded for so doing.

## WASHINGTON AND CHRIS

History tells us that George Washington was a great man, a noble statesman, a soldier in the cause of freedom and humanity, and that he never told a lie. George Washington

resemblance to George Washington.

To the first reporter, the Honorable Christian Schuebel said he did not care to be interviewed regarding the origin of this so-called ordinance. And to a second reporter, who called him out of bed to answer the telephone, the Honorable Christian Schuebel said

"The ordinance came from Portland and that is all I know about it."

The Honorable Christian Schuebel is the foe of all corporations that would grind the noses of the common people in the dust—he says so himself. And the ordinance that he brought into the council chamber was heralded in the county seat before its arrival by an officer of the interurban company which is trying to regulate the jitneys; this same officer expressed the opinion that it would be "fixed up" within a very few days—and after the ordinance "got loose" in the council chamber, this same officer of the interurban corporation "jumped all over the mayor" the next day for having permitted the sacred papers to get out before they were ready for inspection.

Isn't Chris just like George Washington? Yes, he is—not.

## PROGRESS

The times change, and modern cities and communities have to meet conditions unthought of by their founders. And perhaps no greater problem has come before the law-givers than the regulation of motor vehicles.

Two cities in Clackamas county have within the past month or so found themselves face to face with the altered road conditions resulting from the universal use of the highways by motor vehicles. Milwaukie is one of these cities, and Oregon City is the other. The councils of both

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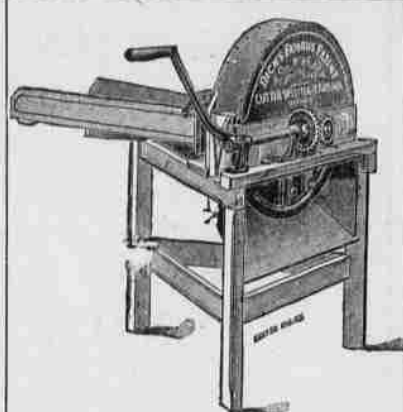
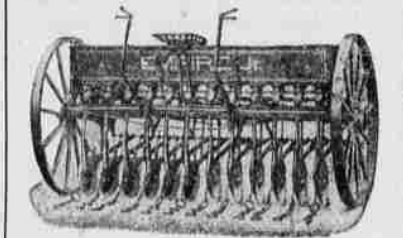
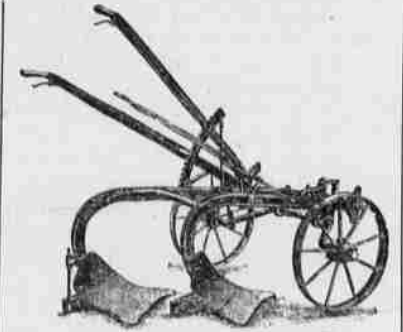


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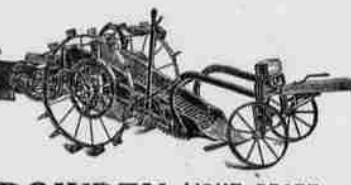
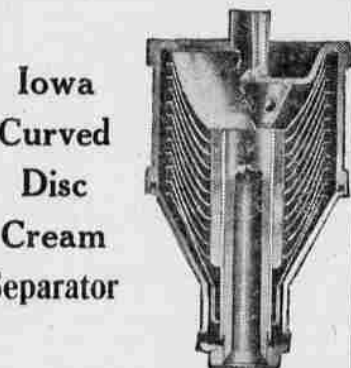
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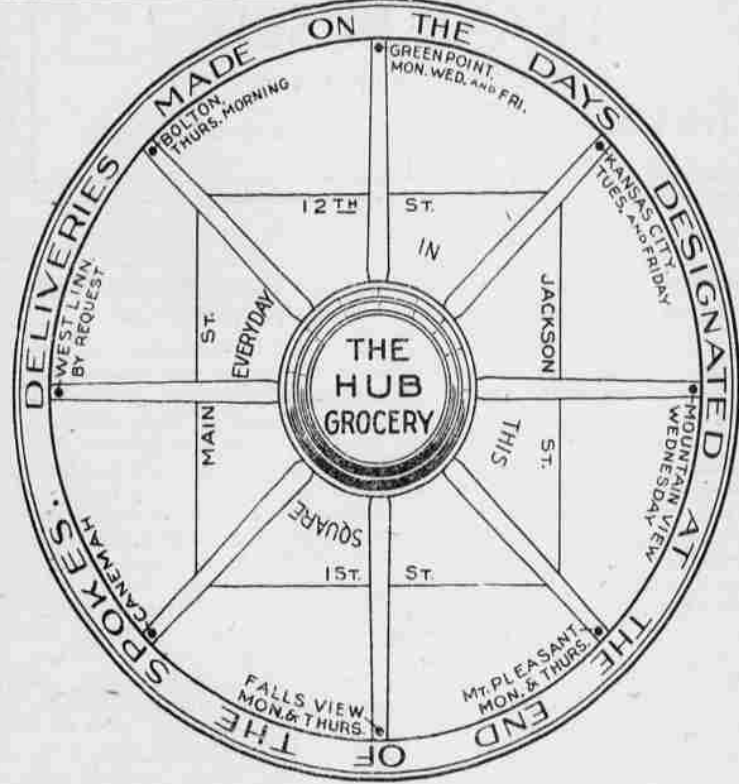
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lives and peace of its citizens, and which city is bowing meekly to the will of a corporation that cannot draw its own chestnuts out of the fire?

Troubles never cease—election is coming next.

Why not hard-surface the roads with the mail-order catalogues; then they'd be useful.

When you do your Christmas shopping early, DO IT AT YOUR HOME STORE.

Thanksgiving Day: an annual American festival, when some of the natives are thankful they didn't eat too much.

Comes now the season of the year when on fair days spiders float thru the air; and when on rainy days spiders crawl in between the blankets.

Oregon City's curfew has been advanced an hour, from nine to eight o'clock. In the rainy season kids won't want to stay out late, anyway.

Just to beat some republican paper to it, we will call attention to the fact that President Wilson issued his Thanksgiving proclamation before the November 2 elections.

Some of the valley churches are holding evangelical meetings to "convert" Pat McArthur to the "dry" cause. This seems like a lot of energy for a trivial purpose.

Speaking of the Journal's "midnight-morning edition," the Telegram remarks that a bull-dog edition is something that is printed today for circulation tomorrow. And yet people are expected to buy it.

It is perhaps worthy of comment that all the newspaper stories about Germany's desire for peace are dated at London; while those which say England is ready to seek peace bear continental date lines.

War influences the fashions. The military coat and suit is with us; and shortly the peroxide blonde will pass away. And war will bring about that change, too—for the war has us up nearly all the peroxide there is.

The interurban line having raised the platforms of its stations, so that modest young ladies in tight skirts could board the cars without undue display, must be overjoyed to hear that "skirts will be shorter this winter."

If the Sunday closing law is designed to provide rest for working people it may get by; but if it is designed to legislate people into church it will prove a boomerang, should it slip

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